Samsara: The Lore So Far

Oct 17, 2026 · By the writer

About this document

This is the lore of Samsara as it stands today: the world, its realms, its beings and the rules beneath them. It gathers everything the writer has settled so far, plus the drafts still waiting for the writer's final word.

- **Settled** means the writer has decided it.
- **Draft** means it is written but not yet confirmed.
- **Open** means it is a known gap, not yet written.

Anything from the early test builds (a test village, a wounded villager, a hungry dog, stand-in bosses, spells and items) only exists to try out mechanics. None of it is lore, and it is left out here.

The heart of it

Samsara is a 2D souls-like where every true death sends you around the wheel of rebirth, the real sky shapes each life, and the goal is not to win but to wake up. It should be fun, and it should also make people think a little about what is really going on: what matters, and what the mind is.

The five pillars (settled)

1. **Samsara is the game.** The world, the deaths and the rebirths are the wheel itself. Everything loops until you wake up.
2. **No chart is better.** Every birth chart is a real way to play. Hard periods are different, never just worse.
3. **Karma is hidden, but felt.** No karma number is ever shown. The world shows it in how it treats you.
4. **Realizing is not knowing.** Answers can be copied. Realization only counts when the lesson has been lived.
5. **Respect the source.** Hindu and Buddhist ideas are true inside the world. Worshipped deities are never bosses and never owned.

Standing rules (settled)

- **The world is the writer's own:** a mystic world with its own creatures, entities and places. It is not Earth, but it lives under the real planets, and their real positions drive its sky, its seasons and every birth.
- **The realms are real places,** not metaphors or states of mind.
- **Deities are encounters.** They belong to the deva realm, as in Hindu teaching. They come at certain times to share knowledge, teach or grant wishes. Spells, relics and chants may carry their names.
- **No one is untouched.** No being, however great, is beyond the six enemies of the mind. What keeps a being where it is, is its own awareness.
- **Ego is the final enemy.** No being can be in this world without an ego, so it is understood and held in awareness, never simply destroyed.
- **Our own words.** Every chant and incantation is written in our own words. Real sacred mantras are never attack spells.
- **Karma is never a number,** not even in text.
- **The source stays a mystery.** What lies beyond the wheel is rarely spoken of and never explained.
- **Voice:** plain, quiet and concrete, close to a parable, rising to grand and epic for the moments that earn it.

The world between

The world is called **the world between** (settled). Each of the nine civilizations calls it by its own name and tells its own story of what it is.

Why "between" (draft). The human realm sits in the middle of the wheel: the gods and demigods above it, the animals, hungry ghosts and hell beings below. It is the only realm that borders all five others. From the middle you can see the whole wheel, with enough joy to rest and enough pain to ask why. That is why only here can a being wake up. It is also why everything leaks in.

> The old women say it plainly: "We live in the doorway. Of course the wind gets in."

The wheel has no beginning (settled). Nobody built it and nobody started it. It turns because beings grasp. Each civilization has its own myth of how it began, and none is the whole truth.

The sky is the wheel's ledger (settled). The nine grahas (the Sun, Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn, Rahu and Ketu) do not cause karma; they show it. When a soul dies, the wheel finds the moment whose sky matches what the soul carries, and the soul is

born under that sky. A birth chart is karma written where anyone who reads stars can read it. That is why no chart is better than another: each one is simply true.

The rim has no front (settled). Time on the wheel is a circle, so a soul is born wherever on the rim its karma fits, often in the past.

> "You were not born after you died. You were born where you belonged."

Colorless, then color, then light (settled). Until the first realization, the world is colorless: only black and white. Color comes back at the first realization, "it is all in your mind". At the very end, past color, there is pure light. Color is the soul's own realization of what is around it, never a lost age of history.

The real sky (settled). The real sky today runs the world. The Moon's daily mansion sets the day's mood, the lunar day shapes small events, the full and new Moons, eclipses and the long seasons of Saturn, Jupiter, Rahu and Ketu all change what happens. A hard sky means tougher enemies and better rewards, never a locked door.

The six realms

The world's dimensions are six real realms of rebirth, each ruled by one of the six enemies of the mind, the *shadripu* (settled). No stay in any realm is forever: a soul stays only until the karma that sent it is spent. Gods fall. Hells end (draft).

Realm	Ruled by	Life there	Who is born there (draft)	Its lesson
Gods (deva)	Pride (mada)	Light, music and ease. Every pleasure spends merit; when it runs out, the god falls	Those with great merit who did good for a reward	Comfort is also a trap
Demigods (asura)	Envy (matsarya)	Endless war over what others have, fought for fruit that grows from their own soil	The strong who measured everything against others	Rejoice in what others gain
Humans, the world between	Desire (kama)	Joy and suffering in nearly equal measure	Souls whose karma is mixed	The only place you can wake up

Realm	Ruled by	Life there	Who is born there (draft)	Its lesson
Animals	Delusion (moha)	Life by instinct, unable to question	Those who lived by habit and never looked	Seeing past habit
Hungry ghosts (preta)	Greed (lobha)	Bellies vast as mountains, throats thin as needles, never full	Those who hoarded and would not share	Letting go
Hell beings (naraka)	Anger (krodha)	Hot and cold hells; Yama, lord of death, judges who comes	The cruel, and those who held hatred close	Anger burns the one who holds it

Devas fall (settled). The old texts tell of five signs that a deva's fall is near: garlands wither, robes grow soiled, sweat comes to the skin, radiance dims, and the deva can no longer rest easy in their seat.

The asuras and the eclipse (draft idea). In the old story, the asura Svarbhanu tasted the nectar of immortality and was cut in two; his head and body became Rahu and Ketu, who still chase the Sun and Moon. Which sky event belongs to which realm is on hold for now.

At the hub: Ego (settled). The final enemy is Ego itself, the hub the whole wheel turns on. To be in this world a being needs its ego; without it, it could not be here. So Ego is overcome, or understood, and held in awareness. Beyond Ego lies the source, and the lore does not say what it is.

Moving between realms (settled, kept short on purpose). Every first life is human. At true death, karma can send a soul to another realm, most often a lower one. Bodhisattvas travel freely between realms.

Doors, fords and what comes through

The sky opens the doors (settled). The other realms touch and leak into the world between only when the sky allows it: full Moons, new Moons, eclipses and other sky events.

> "The sky shows the load, not the road. But on certain nights, it leaves the door open."

Places decide where, and what (draft). When a door opens, things come through where the world is already worn by what people did there.

Where	What tends to come through
Old battlefields, places of torture, homes where hatred lived for generations	Hell beings
Famine villages, hoards, tombs packed with treasure	Hungry ghosts
Hunting grounds, deep jungle, places where people lived by habit alone	Animals
Contested borders, rival cities, thrones fought over	Demigods
Palaces of perfect comfort, gardens no one has to tend	Devas
Markets, pleasure houses, crossroads	Desire, pooling deeper

Fords (draft). A sacred place is a *tirtha*, a crossing place, a ford in a river. Fords lean out of the wheel, toward waking. Temples, great shrines and the places where deities are met are fords.

What comes through (draft).

- **Projections.** Most beings of other realms cannot cross whole. They cast themselves in like a shadow on a wall: a ghost's hunger settled on a well, a god's glow on a mountain shrine. They fade when the sky closes.
- **Crossers.** Some come through whole, most often animals that wander through an open door on a dark night and are left behind. In the world between they find, slowly, that they can almost question. Some go mad. Some become the truest allies a person can have.
- **Demons.** Beings of the hells and the demigod realm that forced their way through; the folk beings of old stories, such as *rakshasas*, *pishachas* and *vetalas*; and, most often, humans who became demonic by their own deeds.
- **Allies.** A projection given what it needs can rest. A crossed beast treated kindly may follow. A demon spared at the right moment may remember.
- **Summoning.** Because every realm presses against the world between, a person with the right words and offering can call across on purpose. Every realm wants something for it.

The kleshas

The sky opens the outer doors. The mind opens its own, and does not wait for the sky.

The taken are many (settled). Countless people in the world between are taken by the sins: greed, lust, anger, envy, pride, delusion, and the running, overwhelming mind. Slowly, one choice at a time, until no person is left, only the sin wearing their shape. Each one was once someone.

Common enemies are projections of the sins (settled). Most of what attacks a traveler is a sin given form. Each sin has many kinds, and they look different in each civilization and among different peoples, because each people sins in its own way.

Sin	Starting ideas for the look (draft)
Greed	Misers grown into their hoards; thin grasping shapes that are never full
Desire, lust	Beautiful from one side only; things that lure and cling
Anger	Rage that outlived its reason; burns everything near, itself most
Envy	Shapes that copy and measure; they wear borrowed faces
Pride	Monuments to themselves; tall, cold, cracked
Delusion	Shifting, looping shapes that believed their own story
The running mind	Swarms and noise; a person drowned under their own thoughts

Their names (settled).

- **The kleshas** are the taken and every projection of sin. *Klesha* means affliction or defilement, the poisons that bind a being to the wheel. In Buddhism, the three root kleshas (greed, hatred and delusion) sit at the hub of the old painting of the wheel of life as a pig, a rooster and a snake. In the Yoga Sutras, the five kleshas are not seeing what is real, "I-am-ness", clinging, aversion and the fear of death. "I-am-ness" (*asmita*) is the seed of Ego.
- **The shadripu**, "the six enemies", are the six rulers of the six realms. The kleshas are their many children.
- **Mara's ten armies** from the Buddhist Sutta Nipata name kinds of kleshas: sensual desire, discontent, hunger and thirst, craving, sloth and torpor, fear, doubt, hypocrisy and stubbornness, gain and fame wrongly won, and praising oneself while scorning others.

The Unmoored (settled name). The taken who went through stillness: ascetics who sat for power instead of release, opened a door inside themselves, and let through whatever their grasping called. Other names from the texts (draft): *yogabhrashta*, "one fallen from yoga", said as a mercy since the fallen are reborn to try again; and *brahmarakshasa*, a learned one who misused learning and became a demon.

The greatest of the taken become the **sin bosses**: the wrongs people commit, given a body.

Deities and great beings

Deities belong to the deva realm (settled), as in Hindu teaching; devas and deities are not separated. Well-known or worshipped deities are never bosses. They come into the world between at certain times, when the sky allows, to share knowledge, to teach, or to grant a wish. Which deities, and how each is met, will be written with the civilizations and their temples.

No one is untouched (settled). Pride rules the god realm, and every deva is its target. The great ones are not immune; they are aware enough to understand what each enemy could do to them. Awareness is the only wall, for gods and humans alike.

The nine grahas are keepers of the ledger (draft). They write every soul's karma across the sky. The nine stones, rare shrines found across the lands, are theirs, which is why a stone can read a soul.

Other great beings (open). Ancient creatures, nagas and garudas, mountain spirits, the oldest crossers: each land has its own, still to be written.

Bodhisattvas (settled in part). Bodhisattvas travel freely between realms. Their stories, and how one becomes a Bodhisattva in the world between, are still to be written. Old tales of beings who vowed to go down into the hells and stay until every soul there was freed are a natural place to start (draft).

The reckoning of the sky

Jyotisha, "the knowledge of light", is the oldest learning in the world between, and it works, because the sky is the wheel's ledger. The mathematics only reads what is written there. When a reading is wrong, the reader erred, never the sky (draft).

Where it came from (draft). The first watchers saw the Moon pass the same star again after twenty-seven nights and a little more, so they cut its road into twenty-seven mansions, the *nakshatras*, each a little over thirteen degrees of sky. They saw the Moon pull away from the Sun by twelve degrees each lunar day, and counted thirty lunar days,

the *tithis*, to a month. Later, their descendants found that the stars slip slowly against the seasons, about a degree in a lifetime, and learned to correct for it. Every part of jyotisha is counting and angles. Nothing in it is guessed.

> "The sky does not lie. It does not speak either. It is written. Learn to read."

Why the ancients relied on it (draft). In the world between, the sky also opens the doors. To know the sky was to survive it: which night the hungry dead would press in, when to sow, when to stay inside, when a deity might come to a ford. Old towers for watching the stars stand among the ruins of every land.

Why some no longer rely on it (draft).

- **They counted wrong.** A people that never corrected for the slow slip of the stars saw its readings drift until they failed, and decided the sky was empty. It was their count that was wrong.
- **They refused it.** Some hold that a soul living by the stars is a soul in chains: "The road is mine."
- **They lost it,** to wars, burned libraries, or a teacher who died too soon.

The nine civilizations each stand somewhere on this (settled). Some live by the sky precisely and navigate every day by it. Some live freely with it, as a clue to life. Some do not use it or believe in it at all.

Astrologers (settled). Readers of the sky are found in every land: temple astrologers, court reckoners, and wanderers who read for a meal and can become friends over time.

Temples and worship (draft). Household offerings of a lamp, a flower, seeds or a lotus petal; shrines for rest and stillness; temples raised on great fords; festivals and rites timed by the lunar day, the eclipse and Saturn's long seasons.

Fate (draft). The ledger shows what a soul carries; it does not say what the soul must do. **The sky shows the load, not the road.** Every choice still belongs to the one who makes it.

The great battle

Long ago, before any people now living, there was a great battle (settled). Every civilization remembers it, no two the same way, and each has its own name for it. No one alive knows what it was fought over, who fought it, or how it ended.

> They fought until the sky itself took sides. When it was over the field was quiet, and the ones still standing on it walked away by different roads, and not one of them ever again forgot to look up.

A fragment of a song. Every people sings a version (draft).

After it (settled). Each people found its own way, bound to its own planet and its three nakshatras, and every one of them came away knowing how much the stars and astrology mattered. How each people came to be bound to its planet is the heart of its own story, written by the writer.

What it left behind (draft).

- **The field.** No two maps agree where it was fought. Some say it runs under all four lands, and every great ruin is a piece of it.
- **The before-ruins.** Worked stone no living people knows how to cut, and shrines that still answer though no one remembers raising them.
- **The silence.** Nothing written survives from before the battle.

What people say happened (draft). The war of the gods and the asuras spilled down. The sky took sides. It was fought over one thing no one now remembers. It never ended, and is still being fought in every quarrel between the nine. None of these is the truth.

A rule for writing it (draft). The lore never says what truly happened. Fragments, songs, ruins and arguments only.

The soul

The rules of a soul's journey, as the world understands them. The mechanics are settled; most of the words are still to write.

The first birth

The first life is the only one shaped by hand. Every life after it is decided by karma.

- **Soul mark.** One small trait (a scarf, a scar, a symbol) that stays on every future body. A soul name is optional.
- **Birth moment.** The player's real birth time, an uncertain time, or "let the wheel decide".
- **The reading.** The chart is cast: lagna, Moon nakshatra, planets, mana. The lagna picks the land, the Moon nakshatra picks the civilization, and the rest of the chart picks the exact place (a village, a forest, anywhere).
- **The birth scene.** A short scene of being born there. Play begins as an adult, in a colorless world. Every first life is human.

Falling and true death

	Falling	True death
When	An ordinary death in a fight or a fall	Prana runs out, or a story event ends the life
What happens	Wake at the last shrine, lose some prana and some of what you carried	The life ends; karma decides the next birth
How often	Many times a life	Once a life

Prana is the life breath. Each life starts with a pool; falling drains it; meditation, good deeds and some shrines restore it. At zero the body dies for good.

- **The soul keeps:** karma (hidden), realization and color, known chants (if the new body has the mana), the soul mark, a few chosen memory fragments, rare soul relics.
- **The body loses:** looks, chart, mana, stats, birthplace, most gear, levels and skills.
- **The past life stays in the world.** The old home still stands and can be reclaimed. The past body lies where it fell, holding what it carried. People remember the deeds, and legends grow.
- **Born in the past.** The next birth is a real past moment, so the new body is at least 18 today. The rim of the wheel has no front: you were not born after you died, you were born where you belonged.

Karma

- Never a number, and always hidden. Intention counts as much as the deed. Unseen deeds (in an empty place, with no reward) weigh twice.
- Built from deeds (helping, harming, sharing, stealing, sparing, killing), from story choices, and from how other beings are treated.
- **After a boss the wheel asks:** why did you fight? No answer is obviously good, and the answer is checked against what was done.
- **Felt in the world:** people trust or fear you, animals follow or flee, shrines open or stay shut. With good karma more enemies beg to be spared; with heavy karma, none do.
- **It decides the next life:** never better or worse, but which realm, and how much choice. High merit offers two or three lives to choose from. Balanced gives one life with a small choice. Heavy demerit gives no choice, and a **karmic debt**: born near the one you wronged, with a task to make it right.
- **Memory fragments** cross death with the soul: two with good karma, one when balanced, none when heavy.

Mana and the five schools

The chart sets how much mana a body has (none, low, medium, high, or rarely great) and what kind. About one chart in five has none, and that is its own path, not a weaker one.

School	Element	Planet	Style
Agni	Fire	Mars	Attack and burning
Jala	Water	Venus	Healing, flow and illusion
Vayu	Air	Saturn	Speed, movement and wind
Prithvi	Earth	Mercury	Shields, stone and the ground
Akasha	Ether	Jupiter	Sound, space and time; rarest and strongest

- **Bodies with no mana** master weapons and body arts, use one-use scrolls, hold gear no one else can, and can turn magic back with a timed parry. They can still chant. Realization can come easier to them, because they are not attached to power. Rarely, one who has walked stillness to its end wakes a spark of mana for that life.
- **Ways of play:** Sovereign (strong alone), Sangha (strong with others), or Balanced, all read from the chart.

The five paths

Path	What it is	How it is walked
Jnana	Seeing through illusion	Paradoxes, riddles, false walls, star tablets, readings
Bhakti	Love and bonds	Friendships, serving a teacher; the path walked with others
Karma	Selfless action, and the warrior's way	Good deeds, mercy, an honest word after a boss, fighting without hate
Dhyana	Mastery of the mind	Stillness, breathing, control over mana
The solitary path	Realizing alone	No teacher and no companions, ever; the rarest and hardest

Progress on a path is hidden and felt at shrines. No path ends in one life. Serving a teacher closes the solitary path for the whole soul.

Understanding and realizing

At key moments, and at the end of deep stillness, a riddle tied to a lesson appears. A right answer with the lesson lived: **"You realized."** A right answer not yet lived: **"You understood"**, which gives power but no color, until a shrine later says "You realized". A wrong answer loses nothing; the riddle returns in another form.

Meditation

Not sleep. A breathing practice at any shrine or quiet place. Thoughts drift in; reacting breaks the calm, letting them pass clears them. Deep stillness restores mana and prana, and clears the eyes, so false walls show for the rest of that life.

The first realization

The first lesson is **"it is all in your mind."** It is not hard to reach, but it is tricky: it is lived by doing the meditation right, letting the thoughts pass and staying with the breath. When it comes, color comes into the world. It can be missed and found later at any shrine or place for stillness; until then the soul lives in a colorless world.

Endings

Finishing the game in the human realm brings the last choice, and there are two:

- **Leave.** The soul leaves the wheel and the game ends there. The life becomes a finished book.
- **Bodhisattva.** Stay, in full color, travel freely between the realms, teach and guide others. Even this can be lost if pride lets Ego return.

The nine civilizations and the four lands

The nine civilizations

There are nine civilizations, and each one has its own planet and its own three nakshatras. That bond is real: each people's way of life carries a true connection to its graha and its lunar mansions. The Moon nakshatra at birth decides which civilization a soul is born into. All nine exist from the start, since a player can be born into any of them, and each is its own starting point with its own journey; at some point the nine journeys connect.

Each civilization's backstory is written by the writer personally. Everything below is only a starting idea, there to be rewritten when each people's story is told.

Graha	Nakshatras	Starting idea
Sun (Surya)	Krittika, Uttara Phalguni, Uttara Ashadha	Rulers and keepers of law
Moon (Chandra)	Rohini, Hasta, Shravana	Healers and river folk
Mars (Mangala)	Mrigashira, Chitra, Dhanishta	Warriors and smiths
Mercury (Budha)	Ashlesha, Jyeshtha, Revati	Traders and scholars
Jupiter (Guru)	Punarvasu, Vishakha, Purva Bhadrapada	Teachers and temple keepers
Venus (Shukra)	Bharani, Purva Phalguni, Purva Ashadha	Artists and musicians
Saturn (Shani)	Pushya, Anuradha, Uttara Bhadrapada	Workers and ascetics
Rahu	Ardra, Swati, Shatabhisha	Wanderers, outsiders and inventors
Ketu	Ashwini, Magha, Mula	Mystics and hermits

The planets keep their real names, since they are the real planets in the real sky the game reads. The civilizations' own names are still to come.

What each civilization will carry, as it is written: its own name for the world between; its own myth of how the wheel began; its own name for the great battle and what it remembers of it; how it came to be bound to its planet and nakshatras, and what that bond means to it; how much it trusts astrology (precisely, as a loose clue, or not at all); its settlements across the four lands; its tribes, crafts and dress; its starting place and the first realization shrine that belongs to it; how its projections of sin look.

The four lands

The lagna's element picks which land a soul is born in. A player's real birthplace is used only for the chart.

Lagna signs	Element	The land
Aries, Leo, Sagittarius	Fire	Deserts and volcanic lands
Taurus, Virgo, Capricorn	Earth	Mountains, forests and farmland

Lagna signs	Element	The land
Gemini, Libra, Aquarius	Air	Highlands, cliffs and sky cities
Cancer, Scorpio, Pisces	Water	Coasts, rivers and marshes

- **No single starting village.** A first life begins in a village, a forest, or any place in the player's land, and the chart decides which. Not random, but different for every player.
- **Each civilization can have settlements in any of the four lands.**
- The human realm spans all four lands across continents.

Shrines and sky stones

Shrines are where a soul rests, wakes after a fall, meditates, prepares chants, feels how far it has walked its path, and is told "You realized".

- **The nine stones (navagraha shrines):** rare, scattered across the lands. They give a reading once a day for an offering.
- **The two star tablets:** hidden deep in the world. They open the long seasons and the periods of a life.
- **Sun and moon stones:** some wake only under the real sky, when the Sun is high or at night.
- Who built the shrines, and why they still answer, is part of the mystery of the before-ruins.

Gameplay notes collected so far

The lore comes first; gameplay waits. These are the notes that have come up along the way, kept apart from the lore on purpose. The lore says what is true in the world between; these say what the player does and meets.

The shape of a playthrough

- **Nine starting points.** The chart decides which civilization, land and exact place a player starts in. Each journey is different, and at some point all of them connect.
- **An RPG of choices.** Conversations and decisions usually offer more than two options, sometimes just two, and the story unfolds in the direction chosen.
- **Everything counts.** How the player treats every person and being they meet feeds karma and shapes the story.
- **The opening:** the introduction, the first fight, the first mount, the first boss, then a shrine or quiet place where the first realization can happen.

- **Astrology is a key part of play.** Players can visit places to have their time read, and meet wandering astrologers and build rapport with them.

The first realization in play

- After the first boss, at a shrine or another place to sit. The place differs for each of the nine starting points.
- Not hard, but tricky: the player has to meditate right and finish it, letting the thoughts pass and staying with the breath.
- The game leaves clues before it. During the first boss fight, for example, a voice or sign might say: *don't sway toward the thoughts, stay with your breath.*
- Players born at the same lagna may go through something similar.
- It can be missed. A player can carry on colorless, or realize it later at any shrine or place for stillness.

The spine under every playthrough

1. **The first birth.** Body and soul mark, the chart cast, a short birth scene, play begins as an adult in a colorless world.
2. **A human life.** Live, fight, fall many times, rest at shrines. Deeds build hidden karma.
3. **True death.** Prana runs out; the wheel weighs the life and picks the next birth.
4. **Rebirth in the past.** A new body at a real past moment. The past life stays in the world.
5. **The first realization.** Color comes into the world.
6. **The six enemies.** Overcome across many lives, in any order.
7. **A path walked to its end,** across more than one life.
8. **Ego at the hub.** The fight is you.
9. **The Self.** A final stillness, not a fight.
10. **The last choice.** Leave, and the game ends; or become a Bodhisattva, and play goes on.

Other realms in play

- Every first life is human.
- Through true death, karma can send a soul to another realm, most often a lower one.
- Access to the realms is found in the world. It never unlocks at random.
- Bodhisattvas travel freely between the realms.

Bosses and encounters

- **Sin bosses** come from the taken: beings consumed by a sin. Common enemies are the projections of those sins, many kinds for each, looking different from one civilization to the next.
- **The six enemies** each have a fight with its own twist, and **Ego** is the final enemy, met and held in awareness rather than destroyed.
- **Deities are never bosses.** Spells, relics and chants can carry their names, and they appear as encounters, never owned and never looted.
- Hundreds of spells, relics and chants are planned. The ones in the test builds are for testing only.

The first version

The human realm only, across all four lands and continents, over many hours of play. The early test builds (the one village, the villager, the dog, the trial zones) are for testing and are not part of the lore.

Parked ideas, not to develop yet

- When the other realms come, each could play entirely differently.
- The asura realm as a 5v5 battle arena, where players fight endlessly.

Still open, and what comes next

Waiting on the writer's final word

Three pieces in this document are drafts the writer is still reading. Everything in them follows the writer's rulings, but they are not locked in yet:

- **The world between:** the jyotisha history, the kleshas, the doors and fords between realms.
- **The six realms:** how each realm acts, and the human realm as the place to become free.
- **The great battle:** what everyone knows, what it left behind, what people say happened.

On hold

- Which sky event belongs to which realm.
- How beings cross between realms, beyond what is already settled.
- How each of the five paths faces Ego.

The writing order from here

1. ~~The foundation.~~ Done.
2. **The world between.** Drafted.
3. **The six realms.** Drafted.
4. **The planets, astrology and the great battle.** Drafted.
5. **The nine civilizations.** Written by the writer, one civilization fully first, then the rest.
6. **Beings:** the taken and the projections of sin, demons, great beings, deities and their teachings, temples and ways of worship.
7. **Bodhisattvas:** their stories, and how one becomes one in the world between.
8. **Traveling between worlds.**
9. Then karma and life in detail, magic, things, and eventually gameplay.

Still to be named and written

- The game's final title ("Samsara" is the working title).
- The nine civilizations' names, and their names for the world, the wheel's beginning and the great battle.
- The names of the four lands, their places, ruins and hidden sites.
- The roster of the taken, the projections of sin, demons, creatures and great beings.
- Which deities appear, when, and what they teach.
- The hundreds of spells, chants, relics and things.
- The words: the birth scene, the wheel's verdict on a life, the riddles of realization, the thoughts that drift in during meditation, the names of the five paths and their gifts.
- What the later realizations teach and unlock.
- How a colorless playthrough unfolds, for a player who never stops to sit.

The lore is written slowly, one piece at a time, and every new idea stays a draft until the writer says yes.